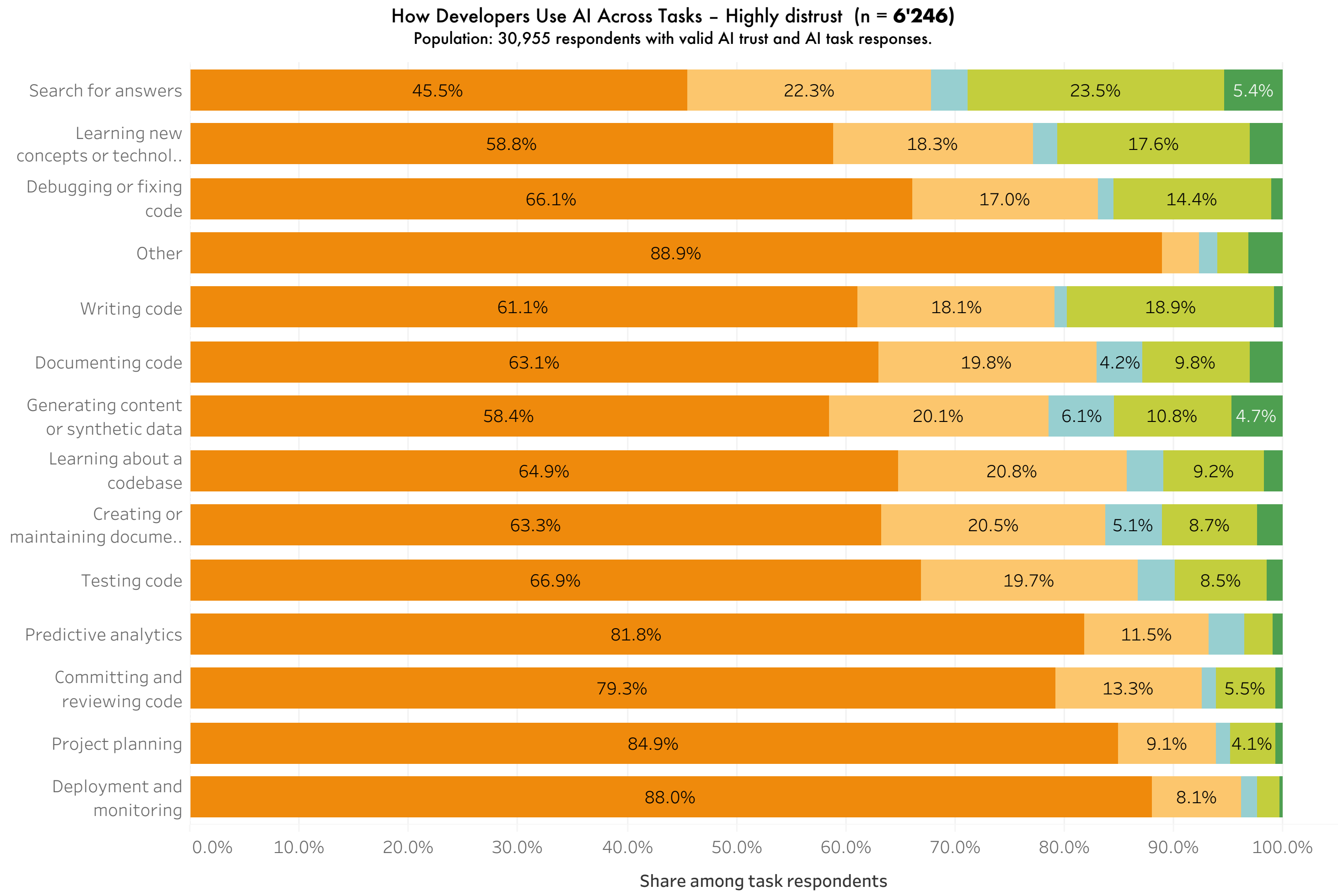
AI Trust, Task Delegation and Frustrations

How developers' trust in AI relates to current use, planned adoption and reported problems



Select a trust level to explore task delegation.

AI Trust Level
Highly distrust

AI Task Status
- Currently mostly AI
- Currently partially AI
- Plan to mostly use AI
- Plan to partially use AI
- Do not plan to use AI

Explore trust by developer role →

Explore frustrations by trust →

HOW TO READ
Each bar shows how respondents in the selected AI trust group currently use or plan to use AI for a task. Percentages sum to 100% within each task.

KEY FINDINGS
Higher AI trust is associated with greater willingness to delegate tasks to AI.
Respondents with higher AI trust are more likely to report current or planned AI use across tasks.
Willingness to delegate varies by task type.
Developers are more open to AI for supporting and information-oriented tasks than for tasks requiring context, responsibility, or judgment.

What Frustrates Developers About AI?

How common AI-related frustrations are across AI trust groups

Population: 31,406 respondents with valid AI trust and AI frustration responses.

The heatmaps compare all trust groups.

Share reporting

7% 74%

	Highly trust n = 945	Somewhat trust n = 9261	Neither trust nor distrust..	Somewhat distrust n = 8304	Highly distrust n = 6270
AI solutions that are almost right, but not quite	58%	74%	68%	69%	50%
Debugging AI-generated code is more time-consuming	27%		42%	52%	53%
I've become less confident in my own problem-solving	27%	26%	21%	18%	11%
It's hard to understand how or why the code works	18%	16%	15%	17%	17%
Other	7%	7%	9%	12%	21%

The "almost right" frustration does not decrease consistently as AI trust increases.

Explore trust by developer role →

Explore task delegation →

AI Usage Context by Trust Level

	Highly trust	Somewhat trust	Neutral	Somewhat distrust	Highly distrust
I don't use AI tools regularly	9%	8%	18%	28%	48%
I haven't encountered any problems	20%	6%	5%	1%	1%

HOW TO READ

Each cell shows the share of respondents within an AI trust group who selected the corresponding response. Darker cells indicate a higher share. Respondents could select multiple options, so percentages within each trust group do not sum to 100%.

"I've never felt frustrated" and "I don't use AI tools" provide context and are not frustrations themselves.

KEY FINDINGS

Trust does not eliminate frustration with AI tools.

Among highly trusting respondents, 58.3% report that AI solutions are almost right, while 26.8% say debugging AI-generated code is more time-consuming.

Debugging frustration increases as AI trust falls.

The share rises from 26.8% among highly trusting respondents to 53.2% among highly distrustful respondents.

AI usage context differs considerably by trust level.

48.3% of highly distrustful respondents say they do not use AI tools regularly, compared with 9.3% of highly trusting respondents.

Notable pattern: "Almost right" solutions peak among respondents who neither trust nor distrust AI, at 73.7%.

AI Trust Distribution by Developer Role

How AI trust differs across the most common developer roles

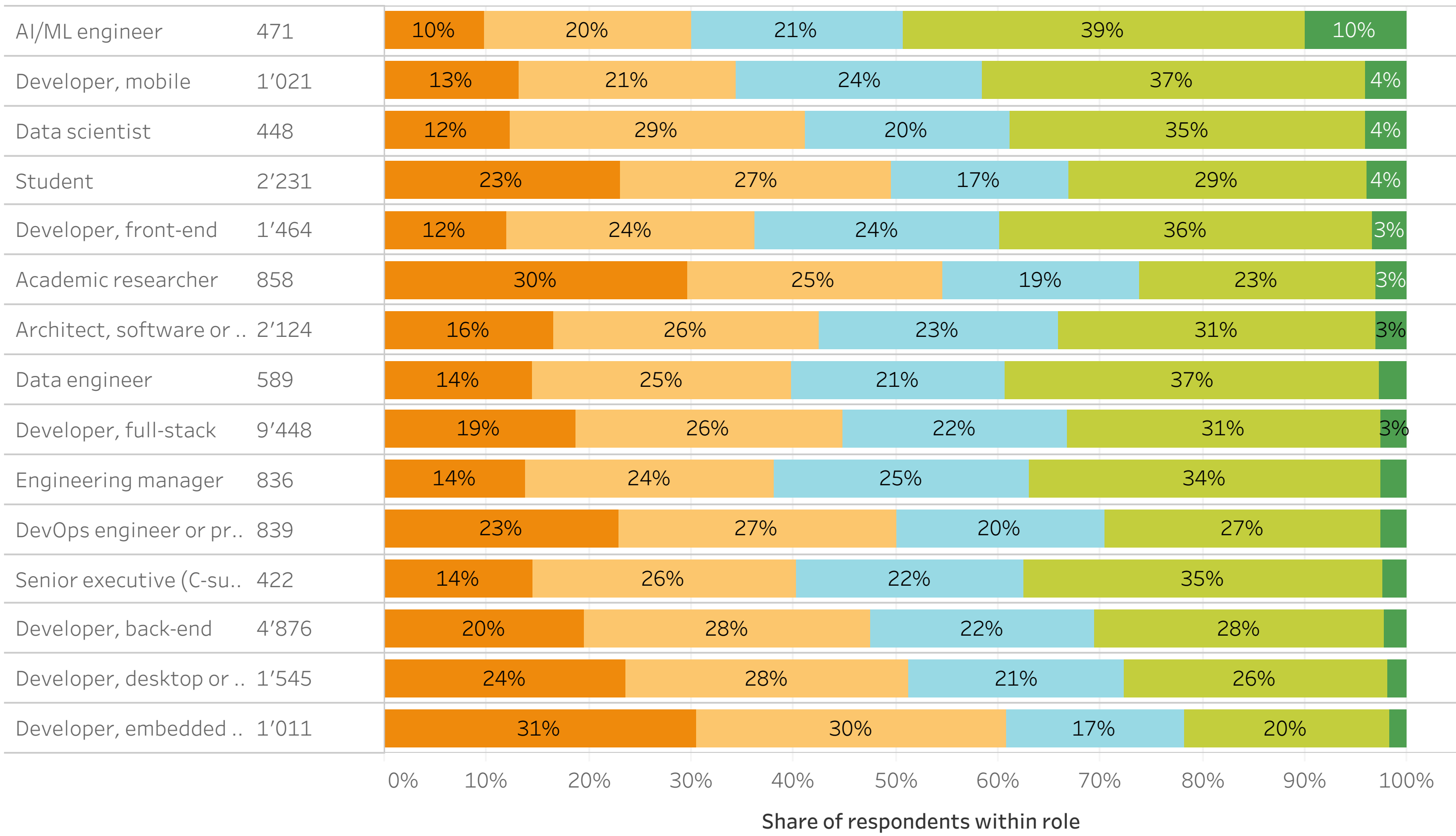
Population: 33,297 respondents with valid AI trust and developer role responses.
Top 15 roles by respondent count, sorted by Highly trust share

Note: Results for roles with smaller respondent samples should be interpreted with caution, as their percentages may be less stable.

AI Trust Level
- Highly trust
- Somewhat trust
- Neither trust no..
- Somewhat distr..
- Highly distrust

← Back to task delegat..

Explore frustrations by ..



HOW TO READ

Each bar shows the distribution of AI trust within a developer role. Percentages sum to 100% within each role. The value next to each role shows the number of respondents. Each respondent is counted under the developer role reported in the survey.

KEY FINDINGS

AI/ML engineers show the highest AI trust among the displayed roles.
49% somewhat or highly trust AI, including 10% who highly trust it.

Embedded and desktop application developers are more skeptical of AI.
61% of embedded developers and 52% of desktop or enterprise application developers somewhat or highly distrust AI.

High trust remains uncommon across roles.
In every role shown, most positive responses fall under "Somewhat trust" rather than "Highly trust."